

THE AVENGERS IN THE 2000s

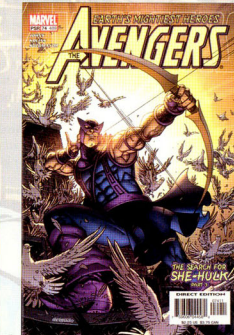
HAVING RESTORED Earth's Mightiest Heroes to fan-favorite status, Kurt Busiek and George Perez explored the Triune Understanding, included Triathlon in the lineup, explored Silverclaw's origin, and revived Madame Masque and Count Nefaria. The Avengers also participated in a major crossover in late 2000 called *Maximum Security*, drawn by John Romita, Jr., in which alien empires tried to transform Earth into a prison planet.

In 2001, Kurt Busiek finished his run with a 16-issue epic in which Kang established his dynasty. Mark Millar and Bryan Hitch took a new approach with the launch of the acclaimed *Ultimates* in 2002, and in the regular Avengers title, Geoff Johns and Kieron Dwyer produced a story in which the Avengers were asked to rule the world. Johns later wrote *The Search for She-Hulk*, in which Jennifer Walters runs amok. Chuck Austin brought back Morgan Le Fay and the Wrecking Crew. He also introduced a new Captain Britain and Invaders. The Avengers disassembled at the end of 2004.

During 2005, the Great Lakes Avengers received a four-issue series, courtesy of Dan Slott and Paul Pelletier; Allan Heinberg and Jim Cheung introduced the world to the Young Avengers; and Brian Michael Bendis and David Finch reassembled a team of New Avengers that included Spider-Man and Wolverine.



Avengers Vol. 3 #25 (Feb. 2000)
A number of old friends and older enemies drop in to celebrate the Avengers' return to greatness at the hands of Kurt Busiek and George Perez. (Cover by George Perez)



Avengers Vol. 3 #74/Vol. 1 #489 (Jan. 2004)
Hawkeye joins the search for the missing She-Hulk. (Cover by Mike Delgado)

Avengers Final (Jan. 2005) The surviving Avengers gather together to reminisce and bid goodbye to each other. (Cover by Neal Adams and Laura Martin)

2000



Avengers Vol. 3 #31 (August 2000)
The Vision returns with the Grim Reaper and Madame Masque. (Cover by George Perez)

2001



Avengers Vol. 3 #46/Vol. 1 #463 (Nov. 2001): Kang conquers the whole Earth. (Cover by Kieron Dwyer)

2002



Avengers Vol. 3 #50/Vol. 1 #465 (March 2002)
Kang enslaves the Avengers. (Cover by Kieron Dwyer)

2003



Avengers Vol. 3 #69/Vol. 1 #484 (Sept. 2003): A toxic chemical is released over Mount Rushmore. (Cover by J. G. Jones)

2004



Avengers Vol. 3 #80/Vol. 1 #495 (May 2004): A new Captain Britain is born. (Cover by David Finch and Art Thibert)

2005



Earth's Mightiest Heroes #1 (Jan. 2005): An eight-issue celebration of all things Avengers. (Cover by Scott Kolins)



New Avengers #131 (Feb. 1973) & #131 (Feb. 1973)
A new tradition begins with a new team and name, and the New Avengers travel to the Savage Land and meet Wolverine. (Covers by David Finch and Danny Miki)